



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

ācārye tu khalu prete guruputre guṇānvite | 2.247a
gurudāre sapinḍe vā guruvad vṛttim ācaret || 247 || 2.247c
eteṣv a.vidyamāneṣu sthāna.āsana.vihāravān | 2.248a
prayuñjāno 'gniśuśrūṣāṃ sādhayed deham ātmanaḥ || 248 || 2.248c
evaṃ carati yo vipro brahmacaryam a.viplutaḥ | 2.249a
sa gacchaty uttamasthānaṃ na ca-īha jāyate punaḥ || 249 || 2.249c

— Manusmṛti, 2.2.15. Life-long Student-II (Chapter 15), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

When the teacher, the Acharya, has passed, your devotion shouldn't waver. Instead, transfer that reverence to the teacher's son, provided he embodies virtuous qualities. If a worthy son is unavailable, extend your respect to the teacher's wife or a relative within the same lineage, treating them with the same honor and care you would have shown your guru.

But what if none of these individuals are present? The text then directs you inwards. It speaks of maintaining a dedicated space for spiritual practice, offering service to the sacred fire (Agni), and diligently tending to your body – understanding it as a vessel for the divine. This isn't merely about physical upkeep; it's about cultivating inner discipline and channeling your energies towards self-realization.

The essence of this section lies in unwavering dedication. It underscores that the Brahmacharya is not simply a phase of life, but a commitment to continuous learning and growth. By adhering to these principles, by maintaining ethical conduct, and by honoring the lineage of knowledge, you purify your consciousness.

The promise is profound: those who live the Brahmacharya life without deviation attain an elevated state, transcending the cycle of birth and death. In today's world, this can translate to honoring your mentors, respecting elders, and continuing your education – whether formal or informal. It means finding ways to serve others, dedicating yourself to your chosen path, and consistently striving for self-improvement. It is a call to internalize the values taught by your teachers and to embody them in your actions. Embrace the spirit of lifelong learning and mindful living to achieve true spiritual growth.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What are the "fires" you tend to in your life, and how can you bring more reverence and discipline to those practices?